63 I can ask for things

A Requests and responses

Requests (in the classroom)	Responses
Can you bring the dictionaries here, **please**?	✓ **Sure.** OK. Yeah, sure. Yeah, **no problem.** Yes, **of course.**
Could you finish this exercise for homework, **please**?	
Yuri, **could you possibly take** these books to the staffroom?	
Elena, can you **change places** with Gabi?	
Could you **lend** me a pen, Boris?	✗ (No), **I'm afraid** I can't.
Dmitri, could you possibly **wait** here a few minutes?	

spotlight **Being polite**

Can and **could** have the same meaning in the table.
Could you possibly ...? is more polite, for a bigger request.
Please is very common, and makes a request more polite.
I'm afraid ... is used to say politely that you are sorry about something.

Glossary



bring



take

finish something do or complete the last part of something
change places e.g. Elena sits in Gabi's place and Gabi sits in Elena's place
lend give something to someone to use for a short time
wait stay in one place for a short time until something happens
I'm afraid I can't = I'm sorry, but I can't NOT ~~I'm afraid but I can't~~

1 **Complete the dialogues with one word in each space.**

▶ Can you clean the board?
1 Can _____ lend _____ a pen? ~ Yes, _____ course.
2 Could you _____ the books here, _____? ~ Yes, _____ problem.
3 Could you _____ wait here a few _____ ? ~ I'm _____ I can't.
4 Lia, can you _____ places _____ Maris, _____ ? ~ Yeah , _____ .

2 **Use the words to write requests and responses. Use *can, could* and *could ... possibly* and different responses.**

▶ take / books / away
A Could you take these books away, please?
B Yes, sure.

1 finish / exercise / homework
A _____
B _____

2 Luca / change places / Maria
A _____
B _____

3 bring / notebook / tomorrow
A _____
B _____

4 lend / pencil
A _____
B _____

5 wait / classroom a few minutes
A _____
B _____

B Asking for and giving permission

Could you lend me your dictionary?

Sure.

Is it all right if I sit in that chair?

Yes, **that's fine.**

Do you mind if I look at your answers?

No, go ahead.



Could I borrow your pen?

I'm afraid I need it.

Is it OK if I close the door?

Yes, sure.

Can I open the window?

Sure, **go ahead.**

Glossary

go ahead OR **that's fine** You say **go ahead** or **that's fine** when you give someone permission to do something.
all right = OK
Do you mind if ...? = Is it a problem for you if ...? (The answer 'No, go ahead' means 'It's not a problem'.)

spotlight *lend* and *borrow*

If you **borrow** a pen from someone, you use their pen, then give it back.
If you **lend** someone a pen, you give them your pen to use for a short time.
*Could **I borrow** your pen? = Could **you lend me** your pen?*

3 Write new sentences. Change the **bold** words. The meaning must be the same.

▶ **Can** we sit down? Is it OK if we sit down?
1 Is it **OK** if I use this dictionary? _____
2 **Is it OK** if I make a coffee? _____
3 **Can** I stay for another ten minutes? _____
4 Is it OK **to** close the window? _____
5 Can **you lend me** your book? _____
6 Can I sit here? ~ Yes, **of course**. _____
7 Can I use the computer? ~ **I'm sorry but** I need it. _____
8 Is it **OK** to have my coffee here? ~ Yes, **sure**. _____

4 Ask for permission. Use different words in each sentence.

▶ You want to sit near the window. Can I sit near the window?
1 You want to go at one o'clock today. _____
2 You want to borrow a rubber. _____
3 You want to go to the toilet. _____
4 You want to sit in a different seat. _____

5 Test yourself. Write five more ways to give permission from this unit.

▶ Yes, sure.
1 _____
2 _____
3 _____
4 _____
5 _____